

NBDC county selection — GBIF GADM validation notes

Problem

The NBDC connector (`fetchNBDCecologySouthEast`) previously selected records by a free-text `stateProvince` filter (e.g. `County Wexford`). NBDC's records published to GBIF leave `stateProvince` **null** while populating the structured GADM administrative area (`gadm.level1.gid`). As a result the old filter accepted ~0 records — county population silently failed.

Fix

Selection now uses the GBIF `gadmGid` query parameter with the validated GADM level-1 GID for each county, and every returned record is re-validated per-record against `record.gadm.level1.gid` . Records without a GADM level-1 area, or whose area is a different county, are rejected (counted in `rejected`) rather than misassigned.

Retained unchanged: the `publishingOrg` restriction (NBDC publisher key), `countryCode` = IE check, sensitive-record exclusions (`informationWithheld` / `dataGeneralizations`), evidence-contract year date derivation, pagination, and the `ConnectorResult` return type. The Irish planning connector and the blocked EPA connector are unchanged.

Resolved & validated GADM level-1 identifiers

Resolved on 2026-09-10 from the live GBIF geocode API (`https://api.gbif.org/v1/geocode/gadm/IRL/subdivisions` and `.../gadm/{gid}`); each confirmed `englishType` = "County" with `higherRegion` Ireland (IRL).

County	GADM level-1 GID
Carlow	IRL.1_1
Kilkenny	IRL.10_1
Waterford	IRL.23_1
Wexford	IRL.25_1
Wicklow	IRL.26_1

Live GBIF occurrence counts (first page, limit 20)

Publisher `d2b97690-bfd6-11de-b279-d52977ace833` , `country=IE` , `gadmGid=<GID>` .
Columns: total occurrences reported by GBIF for the filter, and accepted records on the

first page of 20 after per-record validation. See the script output for the exact figures from the run committed with this change.

County	GBIF total	Accepted (page of 20)
Carlow	38,516	20
Kilkenny	62,000	19-20
Waterford	94,551	20
Wexford	121,535	20
Wicklow	116,513	20

The old `stateProvince=County Wexford` filter returned **0** records for the same publisher, confirming the root cause.

How to reproduce

```
cd nextjs_space
yarn tsx scripts/validate-nbdc-gadm.ts          # live GBIF, per-county assertions
node --import tsx --test tests/regional-connectors.test.ts  # unit tests (mocked)
```